

INBAVANAM

"Happy Forest"

Organisation Profile and Programme Content

Community development in Kandiyur and Bagavathi Amman Koil, Coimbatore District, Tamil Nadu

Compiled and structured from information publicly available on the Inbavanam website. Figures and claims are subject to verification by Inbavanam before formal publication (see Section 18).

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Editorial Note

The following is a cleaned, structured version of the information publicly available on the Inbavanam website. The material has been reorganised, obvious grammar issues corrected, internal drafting notes removed, and the substantive details presented by the organisation preserved. Some pages contain incomplete, dated, or inconsistent information, so figures and claims should be verified by Inbavanam before publication.

1. About Inbavanam

Inbavanam — meaning “happy forest” — is a community-development initiative focused on the sustainable development of economically and socially marginalised communities in and around Kandiyur and Bagavathi Amman Koil villages in Coimbatore district, Tamil Nadu.

The organisation began by identifying two closely connected priorities:

- Education and literacy.
- Collective and sustainable livelihoods.

Its approach is based on working directly with communities, understanding local challenges, strengthening existing capabilities, and developing practical solutions that support education, employment, dignity, environmental responsibility, and community participation.

Inbavanam works with children, young people, women, farmers, tribal communities, community leaders, volunteers, educational institutions, non-profit organisations, and other stakeholders.

2. Vision and Purpose

Inbavanam aims to contribute to communities in which people can:

- Access education and continue their studies.
- Obtain sustainable livelihood opportunities.
- Understand and claim their legal and constitutional rights.
- Participate in local governance.
- Strengthen their communities through collective action.
- Live with dignity, equality, and social inclusion.
- Adopt environmentally responsible practices.
- Resolve conflict through dialogue, empathy, and cooperation.

The organisation's work combines grassroots action with training, awareness-building, advocacy, livelihood support, and practical demonstrations of sustainable living.

3. Communities Served

Kandiyur AD Colony

Kandiyur AD Colony is located in Mettupalayam Taluk of Coimbatore district. The website describes it as a socially and economically disadvantaged community of approximately 75 families.

According to the organisation:

- Most men and many women work as agricultural labourers.
- Many families have worked on landlords' farms for years.
- Families have had little opportunity to save money or build financial security.
- The adult population is largely uneducated or has only basic schooling.
- Many young people have dropped out of school.

- Several young people depend on daily-wage employment or remain unemployed because they lack skills.
- Landlessness limits access to stable livelihood opportunities.

The website identifies several interconnected challenges:

- Illiteracy.
- Indebtedness.
- Alcohol dependence.
- School dropout.
- Open defecation.
- Limited livelihood opportunities.
- Lack of land ownership.
- Unemployment.
- Social exclusion and caste-based inequality.

Inbavanam's response has focused on education, counselling, livelihood development, community organisation, documentation, and collective action.

Bagavathi Amman Koil Community

Bagavathi Amman Koil is located near Kandiyur and is inhabited by the Irular community. The website states that approximately 18 families live in the settlement.

The Irular community has traditionally been associated with forest-based livelihoods, including snake catching. Many families later moved to the plains in search of employment and became dependent on daily-wage work.

When Inbavanam began engaging with the community, the organisation reported that the children were not attending school. Its work has included:

- Regular meetings with children and families.
- Literacy classes.
- Health and hygiene education.
- Visits to the local library.
- Awareness programmes on rural governance.
- Visits to the Panchayat office.
- Engagement with Panchayat leaders and ward members.
- Discussions with government-school headmasters and teachers.
- Advocacy for the admission of children into school.

The programme aims to help children enter formal education while supporting families in understanding public institutions and available services.

4. Education Programme

Inbavanam's education programme focuses on preventing school dropout and creating opportunities for first-generation learners.

Community Activity Centres

The organisation established student activity centres in the two communities, designed as accessible spaces where children could receive educational support close to home. The children named the centres "Will Power Coaching Centre." The website states that approximately 40 children participated in the centres in each of the two villages.

Education Support Activities

The programme includes:

- Counselling for children.
- Counselling for parents.
- Support for children at risk of leaving school.
- Literacy and foundational learning.
- Encouragement to continue secondary education.
- Motivation to pursue higher education.
- Support during college admissions.
- Mentorship for first-generation college students.
- Scholarships for selected learners.
- Access to computers and digital learning resources.
- Library visits and reading encouragement.
- Health and hygiene education.

Support for First-Generation Girl Students

Inbavanam states that it has supported nine first-generation girl learners by:

- Helping them secure college admissions.
- Providing mentorship.
- Supporting their higher-education journey.
- Offering scholarships.

The programme is intended to break intergenerational cycles of educational disadvantage and expand opportunities for young women.

Educational Technology

Chennai-based volunteers helped Inbavanam source six computers for use in tribal hamlets. The computers were intended to support learning and introduce children and community members to digital tools.

5. Agriculture and Livelihood Development

Inbavanam identified agriculture as a practical entry point for livelihood development because many community members already had experience as agricultural labourers.

The organisation acquired approximately five acres of land with the aim of creating a community-based farming collective. The website also refers to the land as five to 5.5 acres in different places; this figure

should be confirmed before formal publication.

Objectives of the Farming Initiative

- Provide land access to landless agricultural workers.
- Create safer and more sustainable livelihood opportunities.
- Reduce dependence on irregular daily-wage work.
- Promote organic and natural farming.
- Improve household income.
- Develop collective decision-making.
- Build knowledge of agriculture and markets.
- Encourage complementary activities such as livestock rearing.
- Demonstrate environmentally responsible farming practices.

Community Farming Model

The website describes a model in which agricultural workers receive access to plots for cultivation. The collective approach includes:

- Community participation in farm planning.
- Shared responsibility for cultivation.
- Collective discussion of farming decisions.
- Support for irrigation and fencing.
- Assistance in accessing government schemes.
- Training in organic farming.
- Financial-literacy support.
- Marketing assistance.
- Profit-sharing arrangements.
- Periodic rotation of land and leadership responsibilities.

The farming initiative is presented as both a livelihood programme and a community-governance experiment.

Crop Development

Inbavanam has experimented with crops including:

- Millets.
- Bananas.
- Other locally appropriate crops.

The website acknowledges that the first crops did not produce strong results and that the land required a period of soil improvement. It also identifies banana cultivation as an early positive outcome.

Additional Livelihood Activities

- Poultry farming.
- Country-bred chicken rearing.
- Goat rearing.
- Fish culture.
- Tree-sapling production.
- Organic and natural farming.
- Local agricultural experimentation.

These activities are intended to diversify income and reduce dependence on a single source of livelihood.

6. Natural Farming and Integrated Agriculture

Natural farming is a central part of Inbavanam's sustainability work. The organisation describes its campus as a practical demonstration site where visitors and communities can observe environmentally responsible agricultural methods.

Inbavanam works with the Krishi Vigyan Kendra and nearby organic farmers to exchange knowledge and improve farming practices.

Integrated Farming System

The campus combines several activities:

- Crop cultivation.
- Fruit orchards.
- Plantain cultivation.
- Coconut trees.
- Local plant varieties.
- Poultry farming.
- Fish culture.
- Water recycling.
- Bio-toilet systems.
- Tree-sapling production.

The integrated model is designed so that one activity can support another. For example, nutrient-rich water from fish culture can be used for irrigation, while treated water from bio-toilets can be used for plants.

Biodiversity

The campus is described as supporting a variety of birds and wildlife, including:

- Peacocks.
- Bulbuls.
- Owls.

The site also refers to occasional visits from:

- Deer.
- Rabbits.
- Wild pigs.
- Elephants, in rare instances.

The campus is intended to demonstrate how farming, biodiversity, water management, and ecological protection can coexist.

7. Access to Justice

Inbavanam works to improve access to justice for marginalised and vulnerable communities.

Its approach focuses on helping people:

- Understand their legal rights.
- Learn about government services and entitlements.
- Navigate legal and administrative systems.
- Overcome social and economic barriers.

- Advocate for themselves and their communities.
- Obtain essential documentation.
- Participate more effectively in public institutions.

Activities

- Legal-awareness activities.
- Rights education.
- Research.
- Training workshops.
- Field visits.
- Community outreach.
- Advocacy.
- Assistance with public documentation.
- Support for community-level problem solving.

The website states that Inbavanam has facilitated applications and helped obtain tribal cards for people in neighbouring communities.

Documentation and Entitlements

Inbavanam's broader community work includes helping people access documents and services such as:

- Tribal or community certificates.
- Aadhaar cards.
- Ration cards.
- PAN cards.
- Other government documents and entitlements.

These documents can be important for accessing education, welfare schemes, employment, banking, identity verification, and government support.

8. Tribal Panchayat Leaders' Empowerment

Inbavanam recognises the important role played by formal and informal tribal leaders in representing their communities. The organisation works to strengthen the ability of tribal Panchayat leaders to:

- Understand their responsibilities.
- Represent community concerns.
- Participate in local governance.
- Engage with government departments.
- Promote inclusive decision-making.
- Advocate for community rights.
- Support sustainable development.
- Connect communities with public programmes.

Key Activities

- Meetings with formal tribal leaders.
- Meetings with informal community leaders.
- Leadership training.
- Rights-awareness sessions.
- Training on sustainable development.
- Field visits to tribal hamlets.
- Dialogue with community members.
- Support for connecting leaders to government resources.

The organisation's field workers and volunteers make regular visits to tribal settlements to understand local needs, facilitate dialogue, and maintain relationships with community leaders.

9. Social Cohesion

Inbavanam promotes social cohesion as a foundation for strong, resilient, and inclusive communities. The organisation works to:

- Bridge divisions between social groups.
- Encourage mutual understanding.
- Promote dialogue and reconciliation.
- Strengthen respect between communities.
- Create a sense of belonging.
- Support inclusive local development.
- Address social inequality.
- Build shared responsibility.

Possible approaches mentioned on the website include:

- Community events.
- Interfaith dialogue.
- Cultural-exchange activities.
- Reconciliation initiatives.
- Public advocacy.
- Inclusive-development work.

The broader objective is to create communities in which people feel valued, connected, and able to participate in collective life.

10. Peacebuilding and Conflict Transformation

Inbavanam conducts peacebuilding training for people from different organisations, including participants from academic institutions and the social-work sector.

Training Objectives

The workshop aims to help participants:

- Understand the nature and causes of conflict.
- Analyse conflict situations.
- Map stakeholders and relationships.
- Distinguish conflict resolution from conflict transformation.
- Develop nonviolent responses.
- Use dialogue and mediation.
- Encourage reconciliation.
- Build empathy and self-awareness.
- Apply peacebuilding principles in daily life.
- Become peace ambassadors in their communities.

Three-Day Workshop

The three-day programme combines:

- Lectures.
- Group discussions.
- Practical exercises.
- Conflict-analysis activities.
- Conflict-mapping exercises.
- Reflection sessions.
- Group work.
- Real-life case discussions.
- Participatory learning.

The programme explores themes including:

- Truth.
- Mercy.
- Justice.
- Peace.
- Nonviolence.
- Dialogue.
- Mediation.
- Reconciliation.
- Personal and social transformation.

The workshop is intended to equip participants with practical tools for addressing conflict at personal, community, organisational, and societal levels.

11. Organisational Capacity Building

Inbavanam provides organisational-capacity-building training for organisations seeking to strengthen their systems, strategy, and community impact.

Training Focus

The programme helps organisations review and improve:

- Vision.
- Mission.
- Goals.
- Strategic direction.
- Programme relevance.
- Internal operations.
- Organisational strengths.
- Areas requiring improvement.
- Future sustainability.
- Alignment with community needs.

Training Method

- Interactive workshops.
- Facilitated discussions.
- Organisational reflection.
- Review of current activities.
- Capacity assessment.
- Strategic planning.
- Collective analysis.
- Forward planning.

The purpose is to help organisations understand their past achievements, assess their present capacity, and develop a more sustainable and impactful future.

The website identifies the following 2024 clients or associated institutions:

- OfERR.
- NDWT.
- VTMS.
- Department of Management, Nirmala College, Coimbatore.

The website uses the phrase “to name a few,” indicating that this may not be a complete client list.

12. Sustainable Development

Inbavanam promotes a development model that balances:

- Environmental protection.
- Social inclusion.
- Economic security.
- Community participation.
- Sustainable livelihoods.

The organisation believes development should be inclusive, equitable, and environmentally responsible.

Sustainable Practices Demonstrated at the Centre

- Organic farming.
- Natural farming.
- Chemical-free agriculture.
- Poultry farming.
- Goat rearing.
- Fish culture.
- Bio-toilets.
- Rainwater harvesting.
- Water recycling.
- Solar electricity.
- Sun ovens.
- Energy-efficient technology.
- Electric vehicles.
- Reuse of old materials.
- Upcycling.
- Tree planting.
- Biodiversity conservation.

The centre functions as a living demonstration site where communities, students, volunteers, and organisations can observe practical applications of sustainable living.

13. Inbavanam Resource Centre

The Inbavanam Resource Centre is designed as a sustainable space for learning, training, accommodation, community meetings, and reflection.

Construction and Environmental Design

The centre incorporates appropriate technology while aiming to preserve structural strength and aesthetic quality. The website identifies the following features:

- Rainwater harvesting.
- Total or extensive water recycling.
- Solar technology.
- Natural lighting.
- Energy-efficient systems.
- Reuse of old materials.
- Upcycling and repurposing.
- Environmentally responsible infrastructure.

Capacity and Uses

- Training space for up to 60 people.
- Board and lodging facilities for up to 30 participants.
- Space for residential programmes.
- Facilities for workshops and meetings.
- A setting for outbound and corporate training.
- A place for rest and recuperation for community volunteers and activists.

Groups Served

- Sri Lankan Tamil refugees.
- Tribal children.
- Elected tribal representatives.
- Self-help-group members.
- Community leaders.
- College students.
- Non-profit organisations.
- Corporate and institutional groups.
- Community-based volunteers.
- Social activists.

The centre is positioned both as a training venue and as a practical demonstration of sustainable infrastructure.

14. Support and Participation

Inbavanam invites people to support its work through participation, knowledge, volunteering, tree planting, agricultural assistance, community engagement, and financial contributions.

Volunteer Opportunities

Volunteers may participate in:

- Natural and organic farming.
- Tree planting.
- Sapling distribution.
- Community mobilisation.
- Education support.
- Rights-based work.
- Visits to indigenous communities.
- Documentation and research.
- Training and mentoring.
- Sustainable-technology experiments.
- Livestock and agricultural activities.

The organisation describes volunteering as an opportunity to work with communities, learn from local cultures, and contribute to improving access to rights and entitlements.

Tree and Sapling Initiative

Inbavanam produces tree saplings that can be planted:

- In homes.
- Along sidewalks.
- In community spaces.
- In other suitable locations.

Visitors and supporters can collect saplings and plant them as part of local environmental action.

Knowledge and Skills

The organisation welcomes people who can contribute expertise in areas such as:

- Agriculture.
- Renewable energy.
- Livestock rearing.
- Community development.
- Training.
- Education.
- Organisational development.
- Legal awareness.
- Social work.
- Environmental protection.

Supporters may share their knowledge, conduct experiments, train community members, or help develop practical solutions.

Financial Support

Inbavanam also invites supporters to contribute financial resources towards:

- Community empowerment.
- Education.
- Sustainable livelihoods.

- Agricultural activities.
- Resource-centre development.
- Volunteer and field activities.
- Sustainable infrastructure.
- Training and awareness programmes.

The website asks people interested in financial support to contact the organisation directly.

15. Core Approach

Across its programmes, Inbavanam follows several common principles:

Community Participation

The organisation works with people rather than simply delivering services to them. Community meetings, local leadership, collective decision-making, and group formation are recurring elements.

Education and Empowerment

Education is treated as a foundation for improved opportunities, confidence, rights awareness, and long-term social change.

Collective Action

The organisation promotes groups, collectives, community leaders, volunteers, and networks rather than relying only on individual interventions.

Sustainability

Agriculture, infrastructure, energy, water, waste management, livelihoods, and community development are approached with long-term environmental and social considerations.

Practical Demonstration

The Inbavanam centre functions as a place where sustainable farming, renewable energy, water recycling, biodiversity, training, and community work can be observed in practice.

Rights and Dignity

The organisation's justice and advocacy work seeks to help marginalised communities obtain documents, understand rights, access services, and participate in governance.

16. Consolidated Programme Summary

Programme	Primary Focus	Main Activities
Education	School retention and higher education	Counselling, literacy, scholarships, mentoring, college admissions
Will Power Coaching Centres	Community-based learning	Student support and educational activities
Agriculture and livelihoods	Stable income for landless workers	Community farming, organic agriculture, marketing, profit sharing
Natural farming	Sustainable food and livelihood systems	Integrated farming, poultry, fish culture, orchards
Access to justice	Rights and entitlements	Legal awareness, documentation, field visits, advocacy
Tribal leadership	Local governance	Leadership training, rights education, Panchayat engagement
Social cohesion	Inclusive communities	Dialogue, reconciliation, cultural exchange, community events
Peacebuilding	Conflict transformation	Three-day workshops, mediation, nonviolence, reconciliation
Organisational capacity building	Stronger civil-society organisations	Vision, mission, strategy, capacity assessment
Sustainable development	Environmental and social responsibility	Renewable energy, water recycling, organic farming
Resource centre	Training and residential learning	Workshops, accommodation, outbound and corporate training
Volunteering	Community participation	Farming, education, rights work, tree planting, skills support

17. Clean Website-Ready Description

About Inbavanam

Inbavanam, meaning “happy forest,” is a community-development initiative working with economically and socially marginalised communities in and around Kandiyur and Bagavathi Amman Koil in Coimbatore district, Tamil Nadu.

Our work began with two priorities: education and sustainable livelihoods. Through community-based learning centres, counselling, mentorship, scholarships, and higher-education support, we help children and young people remain in school and pursue new opportunities. We also work with first-generation learners, including young women entering college, to support them throughout their educational journey.

To strengthen livelihoods, Inbavanam promotes community-based agriculture, natural farming, livestock rearing, fish culture, and other sustainable income opportunities. Our farming initiatives are designed to support landless agricultural workers, improve household income, encourage collective decision-making, and demonstrate environmentally responsible practices.

Inbavanam also works to improve access to justice and government entitlements. We conduct rights-awareness activities, support documentation, engage with tribal communities, and help people understand and navigate public institutions. Our work with tribal Panchayat leaders focuses on leadership, participatory governance, legal rights, sustainable development, and stronger connections with government programmes.

Through peacebuilding and social-cohesion programmes, we promote dialogue, nonviolence, empathy, reconciliation, and inclusive community development. Our organisational-capacity-building programmes support civil-society organisations and institutions in reviewing their vision, mission, strategy, operations, and long-term sustainability.

The Inbavanam Resource Centre serves as a space for training, residential learning, community meetings, outbound programmes, and reflection. It incorporates sustainable features such as rainwater harvesting, water recycling, solar technology, natural lighting, energy-efficient systems, and the reuse of materials.

We welcome volunteers, trainers, researchers, students, organisations, and supporters who wish to contribute their time, knowledge, skills, resources, or financial support. Together, we aim to build communities that are educated, empowered, sustainable, inclusive, and capable of shaping their own future.

18. Information Requiring Verification

Before using this as an official brochure, annual report, donor document, or website copy, Inbavanam should verify:

- Whether the organisation currently works in both named communities.
- The exact number of families in each community.
- The exact size of the farm.
- The current number of children and students supported.
- Whether nine girl students remain under active support.
- The current status of the Will Power Coaching Centres.
- Current farm crops and production results.
- Current agricultural beneficiaries and income data.
- The number of tribal cards and other documents facilitated.
- Current resource-centre capacity.
- Current training clients and programme dates.
- Legal registration and donation details.
- Current contact information.
- Whether all photographs and participant stories have consent.
- Whether claims about wildlife, water recycling, and sustainable systems are still accurate.

The website provides a strong foundation for a detailed organisational profile, but the final public version should include current dates, verified figures, recent photographs, programme outcomes, and official transparency information.